IKEA BRIMNES Chest of Drawers: Assembly Guide

Here are the text instructions for assembling the drawers of the IKEA BRIMNES chest of drawers.

Phase 1: Hardware Checklist

Before you begin, make sure you have all the necessary parts for the 4 drawers (1 large frosted-glass drawer and 3 standard drawers):

- **Wood dowels (101345):** $16x$
- **Long screws (110519):** $16x$
- **Cam bolts (118331 / 112996):** $16x$
- **Cam locks (119030 / 118224):** $16x$
- **Screws (109567):** $8x$
- **Screws (105344):** $8x$
- **Small screws (100365):** $16x$
- **Protective pads (107091):** $4x$
- **Drawer fronts:** 1 frosted glass front, 3 standard drawer fronts
- **Drawer sides & runners:** $4x$ sets of runners (158933), side profiles (123771), and handles ($124328, 128763, 156619$)

Phase 2: Drawer Assembly

1.Attach Cam Bolts to Drawer Fronts: Step 1.
Take all 4 drawer fronts (1 frosted-glass front and 3 standard fronts). Screw 4 cam bolts (118331 / 112996) into the pre-drilled holes on the inside face of each drawer front using a screwdriver.

Verification: All 4 cam bolts are screwed in straight and tightly flush against each drawer front surface.

2.Insert Wooden Dowels: Step 2.
Insert 4 wooden dowels (101345) into the inner side holes of each of the 4 drawer fronts.

Verification: Dowels are pushed firmly halfway into their respective holes on all four panels.

3.Attach Left and Right Side Panels: Step 3.
Fit the left and right drawer side panels onto the protruding dowels and cam bolts of each drawer front. Insert 4 cam locks (119030 / 118224) into the side panels and rotate them clockwise with a screwdriver to lock the pieces together securely.

Verification: The side panels are pulled tightly against the drawer front with no gaps at the joints.

4.Slide in the Drawer Bottom Panel: Step 4.
Slide the thin bottom panel through the grooves along the inside of the left and right drawer side panels until it slots completely into the groove of the drawer front.

Verification: The bottom panel sits squarely in the bottom channel across all edges without buckling.

5.Attach the Drawer Back Panel: Step 5.
Fit the back panel of the drawer into place between the left and right side panels, engaging the back edge of the sliding bottom panel. Secure it using long screws (110519) through the pre-drilled holes on the sides.

Verification: The back panel is firmly attached and squares up the entire drawer frame.

6.Mount Drawer Runners and Handles: Steps 6 - 9.
Attach the handles to the front using screws (105344 / 100365), and mount the metal drawer runner rails (158933) onto the lower sides of the assembled drawers using the specified screws.

Verification: Handles are rigid and wobble-free, and runner rails sit parallel to the bottom edges.

Here are the step-by-step text instructions for assembling the main outer frame of the IKEA BRIMNES chest of drawers.

Phase 3: Main Frame Assembly

1.Attach Drawer Slide Rails to the Base Panels: Step 1.
Position the base/side panels of the main frame and attach the metal drawer slide rails (158933) using the specified screws (100365).

Verification: The rails are screwed down straight, parallel to the base edge, and flush against the pre-drilled holes.

2.Insert Cam Bolts and Dowels: Step 2.
Insert wooden dowels (101345) and screw cam lock bolts (118331 / 112996) into the designated pre-drilled holes on the main side and support panels.

Verification: All cam bolts and dowels are tightly seated and perpendicular to the wood surface.

3.Assemble the Base and Lower Frame Structure: Step 3.
Connect the bottom base structure and lower partition panels together by slotting them over the wooden dowels and cam bolts. Insert cam locks (119030 / 118224) into their housing slots and rotate them clockwise with a flathead screwdriver to lock the base securely.

Verification: The frame joints are snug with no visible gaps between the joined panels.

4.Attach Main Side Panels: Step 4.
Fit the left and right outer vertical side panels of the chest onto the lower frame assembly, aligning them with the embedded dowels and cam bolts. Secure them using cam locks and reinforcing screws (110519).

Verification: The vertical walls stand perpendicular to the base platform without wobbling.

5.Install the Top Panel: Step 5.
Place the top panel over the upper dowels and cam bolts of the vertical side panels. Turn the cam locks clockwise to lock the top panel firmly into position.

Verification: The top panel fits evenly across all four upper corners with a flush, seamless seam.

6.Slide and Secure the Back Panel: Step 6.
Square up the frame diagonally, then slide the thin back panel down through the vertical grooves in the side panels until it rests completely inside the bottom channel. Secure it using the provided panel screws.

Verification: The back panel squares the entire frame, preventing any side-to-side racking or skewing.

7.Mount the Wall Anti-Tip Restraints: Step 7.
Attach the safety brackets securely to the upper rear edge of the dresser frame, mark your wall alignment, drill holes, insert appropriate wall plugs, and drive the wall mounting screws.

Verification: The dresser is rigidly anchored to the wall and cannot pull forward or tip when a drawer is opened.

Inserting the drawers into the frame requires aligning the drawer rails with the cabinet tracks and engaging the safety catch stops.

Phase 4: Installing and Aligning the Drawers

1.Prepare the Cabinet Tracks: Starting from the bottom drawer.
Pull the metal extension rails on the inside of the main frame all the way forward toward the front opening of the chest. Always install the bottom drawer first to keep the frame stable.

Verification: Both inner cabinet tracks are fully extended forward to the edge of the frame.

2.Align the Drawer Rails: Two-person recommended for heavy drawers.
Lift the drawer, angle the back slightly downward, and align the outer drawer runners attached to the sides of the drawer with the extended cabinet tracks inside the frame.

Verification: The left and right side rails rest evenly inside the cabinet channels on both sides simultaneously.

3.Push to Engage the Catch Mechanisms: Steady, firm pressure.
Push the drawer smoothly straight back into the main frame. You may feel slight resistance as the drawer runners click onto the inner cabinet slides—apply steady, level pressure to push past it until the drawer face sits flush against the frame.

Verification: The drawer glides back and forth smoothly without catching, tilting, or scraping against the frame.

4.Verify Drawer Order and Alignment: Glass drawer placement.
Repeat the installation process for the remaining three drawers. Place the frosted-glass drawer in the top slot (or desired position) and the standard drawers below it.

Verification: All four drawer fronts are flush, evenly spaced vertically, and sit parallel with no overlapping edges.

5.Adjust Drawer Alignment (If Misaligned): Troubleshooting uneven gaps.
If a drawer sticks or sits unevenly:

1. Pull the drawer completely out to inspect the runner screws.
2. Ensure all runner screws (158933 / 100365) on both the drawer body and inside the frame are fully tightened and not sticking out.
3. Check that the back panel of the chest is completely square, as a skewed back panel can cause the outer frame to pinch the drawers.
   Verification: Micro-gaps between adjacent drawer fronts are consistent and uniform across the front face.